MONETIZATION PLAYBOOK · SKOOL COMMUNITY MODEL

HOW THE MONEY WORKS

One membership, two prices, three phases. Start with a founding fee that filters for the committed, add a monthly that compounds, then unbundle the content into a product catalog — all off proof you actually built.

The model in one line: $249 to get in · $37 a month to stay · raise the door price and split out products as the community proves itself.

ONE-TIME · STARTUP FEE

$249

Paid once, to join. The commitment gate and your upfront war chest.

RECURRING · MEMBERSHIP

$37/mo

The compounding engine. Low enough to keep, recurring enough to matter.

01 WHY TWO PRICES

WHAT EACH NUMBER IS ACTUALLY DOING

A single low monthly is easy to join and easy to quit. A single high one-time gives you cash but no compounding. Splitting the price does four jobs at once:

JOB 1

Commitment filter

$249 upfront means only people with skin in the game get in. Committed members show up, get results, and stay — the whole community gets better because the door isn't free.

JOB 2

War chest

The one-time fees are real cash now — enough to fund your first hire (an editor) and the tools, without waiting a year for monthly revenue to add up.

JOB 3

Price anchor

Next to a $249 entry, $37/month reads as trivial — "I already paid to get in, $37 to keep it is nothing." The anchor makes the recurring feel easy.

JOB 4 — THE REAL ASSET

Compounding MRR

$37 × every member × every month they stay. Monthly recurring revenue is the number that turns a brand into a business. This is what you're really building.

02 THE REVENUE ENGINE

ILLUSTRATIVE MATH · ONE-TIME INTAKE VS. COMPOUNDING MRR

STAGE	MEMBERS	ONE-TIME INTAKE (× $249)	MONTHLY (MRR) (× $37)	ANNUAL RECURRING
Founding	30	$7,470	$1,110	$13,320
Growing	100	$24,900	$3,700	$44,400
Established	250	$62,250	$9,250	$111,000

Illustrative, not a promise — member counts depend on your content and offer. The point is the *shape*: one-time intake is a per-member spike; **MRR is earned again every month a member stays**. That's why retention (below) is the whole game.

LEVERAGE — RAISING THE DOOR

When you step the startup fee to **$800** in Phase 02, the next 100 members bring **$80,000** intake instead of $24,900 — same effort, 3× the upfront — while founders stay locked at $249. The rising door is both revenue and urgency.

03 THE GROWTH ARC

SEED → SCALE → UNBUNDLE

$249 + $37/mo

Phase 01 — Seed the founding cohort

Open the Skool to a capped founding group at the base price. Deliver week-one wins, and **ideate the specific offer live with them**. Their results become your proof.

LOCK IN **FOUNDERS** AT $249

$800 + $37–47/mo

Phase 02 — Scale the door price

As members, content, and visible transformations compound, raise the startup fee for *new* members toward $800 (monthly can step too). Founders keep their rate — reward + urgency.

RAISE FOR **NEW** MEMBERS

Catalog

Phase 03 — Unbundle into products

Split the community's proven content into standalone products people can buy without joining. Lower entry points, new revenue, and a catalog that funnels buyers back into the community.

ADD **PRODUCTS** À LA CARTE

04

“UNBUNDLING,” EXPLAINED

TURNING ONE COMMUNITY INTO A PRODUCT CATALOG

WHAT IT MEANS

Sell the parts, not just the whole.

Your community is a *bundle* — program, meal system, sleep protocol, mindset, coaching, all in one $249+$37 door. Unbundling = pulling individual pieces out as standalone products anyone can buy on their own, without joining.

EXAMPLE CATALOG (FROM YOUR CONTENT)

- **The 160→205 Program** — your exact training split as a one-time course.
- **Eat Big, Stay Honest** — the real-food/Chick-fil-A bulk meal system.
- **The Sleep Protocol** — a short, cheap intro product / lead magnet+.
- **Natural & Proven** — mindset + faith foundation mini-course.

WHY UNBUNDLE (ONLY AFTER PHASE 2)

- **Lower entry point** — someone not ready for $249 buys a $49 program instead of leaving forever.
- **New revenue** — products sell to people who’ll never join, and to members as add-ons.
- **Funnel back** — every product ends with “go deeper inside the community.” Buyers become members.
- **De-risk** — many products beat betting everything on one community’s churn.

ORDER MATTERS

Unbundle **last**, not first. The products come *out of* content you already proved inside the community. Splitting too early gives you thin products and no proof. Seed → Scale → *then* Unbundle.

05

RETENTION IS THE GAME

MRR ONLY COMPOUNDS IF MEMBERS STAY

THE MATH OF CHURN

At 100 members and 10% monthly churn, you lose ~10 members a month — you have to sell 10 new just to stand still. At 3% churn, you keep almost everyone and every new member *adds*. Same content, wildly different business.

HOW YOU KEEP THEM

- **Week-one win** — every new member gets a fast, visible result in days.
- **Rhythm** — a predictable weekly beat (post, call, challenge) they'd miss.
- **Belonging** — the faith + discipline foundation makes it an identity, not a subscription.

WHY THIS IS ON YOUR "LEARN" LIST

Retention was one of the three skills you named to build. This is why: **the $249 buys the door, but the $37/month compounding is where the real money is — and it only exists if people stay.**

06 TO IDEATE NEXT

THE OPEN DECISIONS — BEFORE YOU OPEN THE DOORS

The model is set. These are the concept choices we make together next (you said we'd ideate the idea later):

- ☐ **The promise.** In one sentence, what transformation does the community deliver? ("Get bigger, naturally and honestly, without wrecking your life.")
- ☐ **What's inside.** The program + meal system + weekly call + community — what's the actual deliverable stack for $249 + $37?
- ☐ **Founding cohort cap.** How many founders at $249 before the door price rises? (A cap creates urgency and keeps it manageable around your job.)
- ☐ **Billing shape.** $249 one-time + $37/mo confirmed — annual option ($370/yr?) to reduce churn and pull cash forward?
- ☐ **The name & the pitch.** Community name + the 60-second founding-member invite you'll put at the end of every video.
- ☐ **Launch mechanic.** Waitlist → founding-week open → close. How you create the "get in now" moment.